



National pride: Three-time World Championships medallist Tajay Gayle soared to the men's long jump title before dedicating the victory to Jamaica, saying the gold was "more for my country than it was for me." ^{AP}

junkie, if you will. When I reflect on myself, I do think that's what I thrive on."

When weightlifting entertains

Anyone who has watched weightlifting at the Senior National Championships in India and then witnessed the competition at the Glasgow Commonwealth Games would immediately notice how engaging the sport can become when presented well.

Held at the SEC Armadillo from July 26 to 30, the competition featured 16 medal events — eight men's and eight women's weight

categories — making it one of the busiest competitions at the Games.

What truly stood out, though, was the presentation. The announcements were clear, informative and often humorous, keeping spectators engaged throughout.

Whenever a contest went down to the final lift, the crowd roared in support of their country's lifters. Watching weightlifting generate such sustained excitement was an eye-opener.

A dancer's story

After taking a wrong turn one evening, I found myself completely lost.

As I tried to figure out how to get back, I approached an elderly woman for directions. The 61-year-old turned out to have a Commonwealth Games story of her own.

"Friends told me about the auditions. I tried, got selected and thoroughly enjoyed being part of the Games," she said. She had been one of the dancers at the Opening Ceremony.

Gold for Jamaica

Three-time World Championships medallist Tajay Gayle of Jamaica arrived in Glasgow as one of the biggest stars of the athletics competition.

As expected, he won the men's long jump gold, consigning India's Murali Sreeshankar to the silver medal.

Speaking to the Indian media afterwards, Gayle said the victory meant far more than personal glory.

"I appreciate it because this was mostly for my country. I had to adjust my schedule this year. It was more for Jamaica than it was for me, really," he said.